



Scholarship Essay Workbook

Turn your story into a focused, memorable scholarship essay.

MADE FOR

High school seniors, college students, and adult learners

Use this toolkit as a planning guide. Requirements, deadlines, and availability are set by each school, scholarship, agency, or provider. EFF cannot guarantee funding or outside assistance.

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1. Build your story bank

Before writing, collect moments that reveal your values. Specific scenes are stronger than general claims.

- A challenge that changed how I think or act
- A responsibility I carried for my family, school, work, or community
- A moment I served, led, created, or solved a problem
- A goal connected to my education and the people I hope to help

Three moments I could write about

2. Use the STORY structure

S - Scene	Open with a real moment the reader can picture.
T - Tension	Explain the challenge, decision, or need without exaggerating.
O - Ownership	Show what you did, learned, changed, or built.
R - Relevance	Connect the experience to your education and purpose.
Y - Your next step	Explain what the scholarship makes possible.

Draft your opening scene

3. Final review

- I answered the exact prompt
- My opening includes a specific scene
- I showed growth with evidence
- I named a realistic educational goal
- I explained impact without promising perfection
- I removed repeated ideas and checked the word limit
- A trusted person reviewed grammar and clarity

AI NOTE

Use technology to brainstorm or proofread, but keep the experiences, voice, and final claims truthful and your own.